



CHAPTER 61

An Act to extend the power of the Minister of Fuel and Power to make advances to the National Coal Board for capital purposes; and to alter the financial year of the National Coal Board. [2nd August, 1956]

BE it enacted by the Queen's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:—

1. For the proviso to subsection (1) of section twenty-six of the Coal Industry Nationalisation Act, 1946, as substituted by subsection (1) of section one of the Coal Industry Act, 1951 (which provides that the aggregate amount of the principal outstanding in respect of advances by the Minister of Fuel and Power to the National Coal Board for capital purposes shall not at any time exceed three hundred million pounds and that the aggregate amount of such advances in any financial year shall not exceed forty million pounds or such greater amount as may be specified for that year in an order made by that Minister) there shall be substituted the following, that is to say—

“ Provided that the aggregate amount outstanding by way of principal—

(a) in respect of advances under this section made before the expiration of five years from the commencement of the Coal Industry Act, 1956—

(i) shall not at any time exceed six hundred and fifty million pounds; and

(ii) shall not at any time in any financial year exceed by more than seventy-five million pounds (or such greater sum as the Minister may by order specify for that year) the highest aggregate amount so outstanding at any time during the immediately preceding financial year; and

- (b) in respect of advances under this section made after the expiration of the said five years shall not exceed such amount as Parliament may hereafter determine ”.

Alteration of financial year of National Coal Board.

2. The current financial year of the National Coal Board shall end at midnight of the twenty-ninth day of December, nineteen hundred and fifty-six, and thereafter the financial year of the said Board shall be the period beginning at midnight of the Saturday falling on or nearest to the thirty-first day of December of one calendar year and ending at midnight of the Saturday falling on or nearest to the thirty-first day of December of the next following calendar year; and accordingly in subsection (1) of section sixty-three of the Coal Industry Nationalisation Act, 1946, the paragraph beginning with the words “ financial year of the Board ” is hereby repealed.

Citation and extent.

3.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Coal Industry Act, 1956, and the Coal Industry Acts, 1946 to 1951, and this Act may be cited together as the Coal Industry Acts, 1946 to 1956.

(2) This Act shall not extend to Northern Ireland.

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